



Turn off eye candy in Quake III to get higher frame rates

ning *Quake III* at 16-bit colour, keep in mind that swiching over to 32-bit rendering, though it's higher quality, will definitely give that frame rate drop. Optimal settings would be **r_colorbits 16** while going back to 32-bit would be **r_colorbits 32**.

Sky, no sky: While all the dynamic sky effects and see-through portals look great, turning them off will yield much better performance. To set optimal performance use **r_fastsky 1**. To go back to eye candy, use **r_fastsky 0**

Pretty flashes: Weapons in *Quake III* come with some very realistic lighting and flare effects, but at the cost of performance. To turn it off, use **r_dynamicLight 0**. Turn it back on with **r_dynamicLight 1**

Curves cost more: Turning off those pretty curves in *Quake III* could do wonders for performance. Do that by setting **r_nocurves 1**. If you want to get back to the curves, use **r_nocurves 0**

UT2003

Advanced tweaks

UT2003's main settings can be accessed from the UT2003.ini file located under the System folder of the

install. While all the simpler graphics tweaks can be set from within the settings menu, you can tweak this file to give that extra performance boost. Open the UT2003.ini file in any text editor to try out these tweaks. Before you start to edit the file, be sure to back it up, in case you want to restore the original settings. Scroll down the file and locate all these settings under **[D3DDrv.D3DRender Device]**, unless mentioned otherwise.

Pre-caching textures: Set **'UsePrecaching=False'** to disable loading of textures into video memory while loading the level, especially if you are using a graphics card with 32 MB of video memory. This should give you smoother gameplay. On the other hand, should you have a card with 64 MB or more, you can set this to True.

Trilinear texture filtering: Setting **'UseTrilinear=True'** will enable trilinear texture filtering, which will give you enhanced quality but you might suffer a performance hit on older cards. To turn it off, set it to False

Compressed lightmaps: If this is enabled, your loading times will increase, but you should see increased in-game performance. Enable it with **'UseCompressedLightmaps=True'**. On the other hand, if you happen to have a very high-end graphics card, such as one with 128 MB of video RAM or more, you can disable this to get more realistic, uncompressed lightmaps.

Minimum frames: Again,



Anti-Aliasing, Anisotropic Filtering turned off in UT2003

this one is recommended only if you happen to have

jumping frame rates and would like to stick to a defined value. Locate **'MinDesiredFrameRate= 35.000000'** under **[WinDrv.WindowsClient]**. As you can see, the default is 35 frames per second. Increase this to a value that you believe is sustainable for your system. UT2003 will compensate by reducing eye candy through the game play, and try to maintain the frame rates around this number.

TWEAKING PDAS



Unlike mobile phones, PDAs are like mini-computers and can be tweaked to yield better performance. A PDA can be tweaked in two ways—overclocking and using a tweak utility. Everything is faster when a PDA is overclocked; unfortunately the battery drains quicker too. The other option is to use a tweaking utility that raises the CPU clock speed only when required—such as when playing a game—and lowers the clock when using less CPU intensive applications. This provides you with a device that is fast when you

need it, and the battery lasts longer too—unless you play games all day!

Caution: before playing with clock frequencies, make sure you know what you're doing, or else you might damage the CPU. Remember, overclocking increases CPU power and reduces battery life, while underclocking reduces CPU power and increases battery life. Also, be careful to make changes in small increments, and check the performance-to-stability ratio. Last but not least, always backup your data.

The utilities available depend on what CPU and



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